Donovan Ellison

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SKILLS

Technologies: AWS, GCP, Github Actions, Helm, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, and Jenkins

Programming: Go, Python, CSS, HTML, and JavaScript

Certifications: GIAC Cloud Security Automation Certification (GCSA)

EXPERIENCE

Security Engineer, *Ontra* — **Sep 2024 — Present**

- Automated vulnerability intake and routing across 5+ sources, tracking 1,000+ findings, assigning SLA due dates and owning teams, and auto-closing 242 Jira tickets after fixes or triage.
- Built an AI vulnerability triage agent that assessed business risk and assigned owning teams, identifying 60% of 438 reviewed tickets as false positives over 6 months as quarterly intake rose ~13x; an approval gate held Jira and Semgrep writes until review.
- Defined security requirements for Infrastructure's service-mesh and Gateway API migration for east-west mTLS; used gateway benchmark data to inform controller selection and contributed to Linkerd service-policy and Kgateway proofs of concept.
- Owned the Rad Security runtime agent on 10 production and staging AWS EKS clusters, keeping Kubernetes threat detection and audit logging current through 12 merged Helm and Terraform PRs.
- Built and operated an open-source threat modeling app on EKS and RDS with Terraform, Helm, GitHub Actions, and Okta OIDC; after an adoption review, moved the workflow to Notion, which supported 30+ threat models in its first year.
- Responded to the November 2025 Shai-Hulud campaign by deploying a Semgrep rule to block indicator files on announcement day; after a retrospective, built a script to check Semgrep's dependency inventory against compromised-package lists, later using it during mini-Shai-Hulud and Axios campaigns.

Senior Cloud Security Engineer, *apree health* — **Mar 2024 — Sep 2024**

- Optimized Terraform pipelines, decreasing approval and request processing times by over 80%, enhancing efficiency and usability for both approvers and requesters.
- Partnered with engineering teams to deploy Renovate across 100+ repositories, automating dependency management. This proactive approach mitigated Critical and High vulnerabilities in over 50 production services, significantly enhancing security posture.
- Facilitated the deployment of a self-service access portal, resulting in a 66% reduction in group request completion times and ensuring adherence to SOC II and HITRUST access controls.
- Streamlined and optimized the setup and coordination of AWS and GCP pentests, reducing the overall setup time by 50%.

Cloud Security Engineer, *apree health* — **Jan 2022 — Mar 2024**

- As the inaugural Cloud Security Engineer, led security initiatives throughout a year-and-a-half long data center migration to GCP.
- Enforced CIS standards with Policy-as-Code for hundreds of GCP projects, ensuring compliance with encryption key usage and preventing misconfigurations such as publicly accessible GCS buckets.
- Successfully implemented egress filtering for URLs in PHI environments, a pivotal step in achieving HITRUST certification.
- Orchestrated the deployment of DiscrimiNAT across 6 VPCs, effectively filtering traffic in 27 environments with over 900 unique FQDNs.
- Developed a Python Flask app that enables developers to bypass the 24-hour SLA for FQDN additions by quickly creating temporary egress firewall rules in lower environments. This innovation saved thousands of engineering hours, allowing uninterrupted development and testing.
- Introduced sprint planning, backlog grooming, and retrospective sessions, resulting in an outstanding 77% reduction in Lead Time for ticket completion, from an average of 61.3 days to just 13.8 days after 3 months.

Site Reliability Engineer, *Zapproved* **Mar 2021 — Jan 2022**

- Enabled AWS Systems Manager for several dozen EC2 instances, providing secure remote command execution, automated patching, and granular access control to instances.
- Architected an AWS solution for managing SSH keys on TeamCity agents across multiple AWS accounts, enhancing security and access management.
- Analyzed and resolved an Elasticsearch cluster issue that caused day long logging outages, sometimes multiple times a week.
- Spearheaded the refactoring of the AWS Elastic Kubernetes Service (EKS) provisioning and configuration.
- Developed a roadmap for Kubernetes improvements by evaluating different tools, researching best practices, creating proof of concepts, and meeting with key stakeholders.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in **Computer Science, University Honors** **Sep 2016 — Aug 2020**

Portland State University